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DJIA 52177.69 ▲ 556.21 1.08% NASDAQ 26713.03 ▲ 0.1% STOXX 600 640.16 ▲ 0.4% 10-YR. TREAS. ▲ 25/32, yield 5.086% OIL $97.97 ▲ $2.88 GOLD $4,147.70 ▲ $62.90 EURO $1.1222 YEN 157.99

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** rose, with the S&P 500, Dow and Nasdaq gaining 0.3%, 1.1% and 0.1%, respectively. The yield on the 10-year U.S. Treasury note settled at 5.086%, down from 5.189% Wednesday. **B1**

◆ **Sales at U.S. retailers** rose in September, but at a slower pace than in August, Commerce Department data show. **A2**

◆ **Netflix's chief content** officer, Bela Bajaria, is leaving the company as it struggles to engage viewers and stimulate growth. She will be succeeded by Peter Rice. **B1**

◆ **Meta Platforms released** an open-weight artificial-intelligence model and is collaborating with Apple to run it locally on the company's high-end Mac computers. **B1**

◆ **TSMC raised the** prospect of additional U.S. manufacturing capacity beyond Arizona as demand for AI chips continues to outpace supply. **B4**

◆ **KFC struck a deal** to take on Coca-Cola as its beverage provider at thousands of U.S. restaurants in a blow to longtime supplier PepsiCo. **B3**

◆ **YouTube has had** discussions with publishers about developing an audiobook feature, an offering that could be ready next year. **B4**

◆ **Pernod Ricard said** it is preparing for a potential listing in India, looking to capitalize on growing demand there as sales fall in many of the group's other markets. **B3**

◆ **Ericsson shares** surged as investors cheered strong growth in sales of network gear, shrugging off a company warning that higher parts costs will impede profitability next year. **B4**

Worldwide

◆ **Progress toward a** U.S-Mexico tariff deal stalled after opposition from Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick, the second time recently that he has had a hand in upending advanced negotiations with a North American partner. **A1**

◆ **The Justice Department** sued California in an attempt to block the state from counting mail-in ballots it receives from 20,000 people the Trump administration says may not be U.S. citizens. **A3**

◆ **The FBI said it was** investigating suspicious mailings sent to election offices across the country just weeks before the midterm elections. **A3**

◆ **Three children** and one teacher were killed in a shooting at an elementary school in Bend, Ore., and the 16-year-old suspect was shot and killed by a community member who followed the shooter into the school. **A3**

◆ **Republicans are** playing defense on an expanding electoral map, spending hundreds of millions of dollars in the final stretch to the midterms to prevent a Democratic takeover of Congress. **A1, A4**

◆ **Minnesota turned** into a political Rorschach test after two state flashpoints became nationalized and part of this year's midterm election debate. **A5**

◆ **Trump said the** execution by firing squad of condemned killer Nidal Hasan won't be livestreamed, reversing a decision by Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth. **A4**

◆ **The roof of a** school collapsed in Peshawar, Pakistan, killing at least 34 children and a teacher and injuring more than 50 people. **A6**

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Sky-High Fuel Prices Widen World's Growth Gap



JOHANNES CHRISTO/REUTERS

RUNNING ON EMPTY: Motorcyclists line up for gasoline Thursday in Indonesia, where high prices have sparked protests. Economic damage from the rising cost of fuel and of borrowing are stifling most countries while only those leading the AI boom grow. **A7**

Trump's Sudden Turn on Kyiv Triggers Confusion, Mistrust

*By **Robbie Gramer**, **Lindsay Wise** and **Marcus Walker***

In the early hours of Wednesday, Denys Sienik, the top Ukrainian diplomat in Washington, D.C., sent a frantic message to U.S. lawmakers: Ukraine was suddenly facing restrictions on its military-grade Starlink terminals, and he didn't know why. The change, Sienik warned, would give Russia an upper hand in the war and make it tougher for Kyiv to intercept strikes.

Other Ukrainian officials were suspecting the worst: President Trump ordered Elon Musk, who owns the company that operates Starlink, to throttle Kyiv's access to the satellite systems. The suspicions, which haven't been confirmed, underscore the extent to which the U.S.-Ukraine relationship has soured as Trump presses to end the war.

On Thursday, Ukraine resumed strikes on Russian refineries after accusing Moscow of violating Trump's ceasefire on energy targets, and as its military regained full access to Starlink.

Long-range drones, which don't require Starlink connections, attacked Ryazan oil refinery, where a fire broke out, Russian officials said. The strike ended a dayslong pause in Ukrainian attacks on Russian energy infrastructure, during which Moscow repeatedly defied the Trump-imposed truce.

"That's it. The block is out," President Volodymyr Zelensky of Ukraine said in an interview with the Financial Times published on Thursday, referring to Ukraine's moratorium on refinery strikes.

Ukraine hasn't officially claimed responsibility for the Ryazan attack.

Kyiv is navigating an increasingly fraught relationship with Washington. In recent

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◆ **Ukraine needs arms, intel only U.S. can provide..... A6**

Lutnick Snarls Tariff Pact With Mexico

Commerce secretary objects to significant cuts in levies on steel, aluminum and autos

By Gavin Bade And Santiago Pérez

Progress toward a U.S-Mexico tariff deal has stalled after opposition from Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick, people familiar with the talks said, the second time recently that he has had a hand in upending advanced negotiations with a North American partner.

The U.S. and Mexico had been zeroing in on a deal that would reduce U.S. levies on steel, aluminum and automobiles in exchange for a series of concessions from Mexico, these people said, paving the way for further talks on renewing the U.S.-Mexico-Canada Agreement.

Mexican officials and many corporate executives expressed optimism that a deal was close, they said.

But in recent days, progress toward a deal has slowed considerably, the people said, because of disagreements over the U.S. tariffs on vehicles and metals, which are imposed on national-security grounds and are administered by Lutnick's department.

Lutnick has opposed significant reductions in the 25% tariff on Mexican automobiles and the 50% tariff on steel and aluminum, the people said. Also on metals, he has objected to reductions in tariffs on so-called derivative products—finished products made of steel and aluminum. Domestic aluminum companies have told the administration that any reduction in these levies would undermine U.S.

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OpenAI Suspect Kept Ties To Saudis

By Maxwell Zeff And Abeer Ayyoub

When Saudi Arabia's Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman appeared at an event in Silicon Valley with young Saudi tech workers in the summer of 2016, a new graduate from Massachusetts Institute of Technology was looking for guidance on whether to return to his homeland.

Prince Mohammed told the group that the better strategy was to hone skills in the U.S. before coming back to the kingdom, the young graduate, named Abdulrahman Alfozan, recalled in a recently released podcast interview.

"You learn from the source and then, God willing, bring that experience and knowledge back to the homeland," Alfozan said.

A decade later—after stints at Meta Platforms and a startup backed by Andreessen Horowitz—Alfozan allegedly booked one-way plane tickets to Saudi Arabia from San Francisco for himself, his spouse and a family member.

Three days before he was to depart, he was arrested by the Federal Bureau of Investigation and charged with trying to record secret conversations within his latest employer, OpenAI, which fired him that day.

Federal prosecutors allege the 35-year-old Alfozan had spent weeks scoping out an executive conference room inside an OpenAI office building

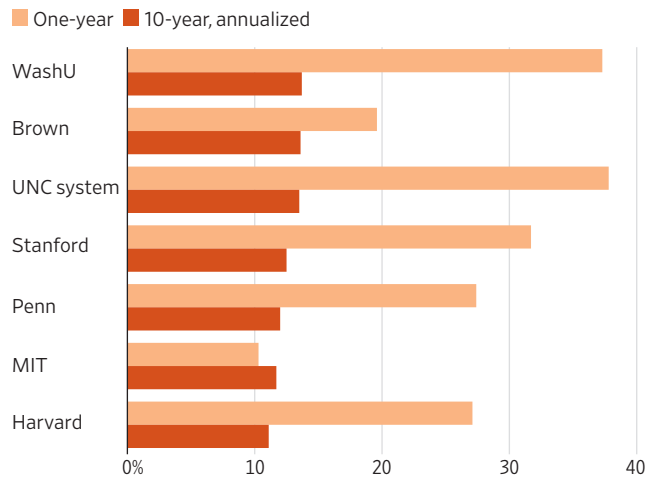
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◆ **AI giants' cat-and-mouse game with spies..... B1**

SpaceX, AI Lift Endowments

U.S. college and university endowments are having their strongest returns in five years thanks in part to gains from SpaceX and bets on artificial intelligence. **A3**

Endowment returns over one- and 10-year periods



Note: Returns are for fiscal years ended June 30, 2026.
Universities including Dartmouth, Princeton and Yale have not yet reported.
Source: the schools

GOP Midterm Angst Rises as Map Widens

By Sabrina Rodriguez And Olivia Beavers

WASHINGTON—Republicans are playing defense on an expanding electoral map, spending hundreds of millions of dollars in the final stretch of the midterms to prevent a Democratic takeover of Congress as campaigns nationwide reach a fever pitch.

With less than three weeks until the election, deep-pocketed GOP groups are trying to push candidates over the finish line, while President Trump and Vice President JD Vance are crisscrossing the country to shore up Republican support in red areas that seemed unassailable just months ago.

Democrats, working to capitalize on Trump's weak approval ratings and economic concerns amid the war with Iran, have expanded their target map into more Republican-leaning territory. That has forced Republicans to pour in huge sums to defend traditionally safe red seats, while attempting to pick off some seats in purple states such as Michigan and New Hampshire to help stanch potential losses.

In the waning days of campaign season, Republicans hope money and structural advantages in the electoral map will

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◆ **Jump in gasoline prices hits battleground states..... A4**

Has Britain Lost Its Mojo? Exhibit A Is Oxford's New Bridge.

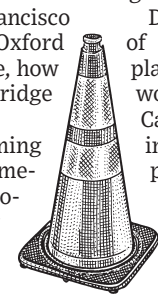
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'Ludicrously ugly' structure took longer to build than Eiffel Tower—and cost more

By Joanna Sugden

OXFORD, England—Venice has the Rialto. San Francisco has its Golden Gate. Oxford has the...wait a minute, how much did that new bridge cost?

This city of dreaming spires has lit the Promethean flame under poets and artists for centuries, but its latest architectural offering—20-yard rail and foot bridges connecting Oxford Station over Botley Road—has underwhelmed. Especially as the structures cost over a quarter of a billion dollars, and, to some, are giving nothing but "loveless ugliness."



Slow zone

During more than a decade of Britain's tinkering and planning, China built the world's highest bridge and Canada forged a river crossing to the U.S. In centuries past, the British built the Titanic in less time and for less money. The French erected the Eiffel Tower more quickly and cheaply, even after adjusting for inflation.

Detractors say it's Exhibit A that Britain has lost its mojo.

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Tether Steered Funds To Firms of Trump Crypto Adviser

Bo Hines crafted stablecoin legislation

By Sam Kessler

Lawmakers and executives crowded into the East Room of the White House in July 2025 to watch President Trump sign the Genius Act, a landmark crypto bill that set rules for selling stablecoins pegged to the U.S. dollar.

From a podium, Trump rattled off thank-yous to the law's architects. "Where's Bo Hines?" he asked. The president's 29-year-old crypto adviser rose from the front row to applause.

What most people in the room didn't know: While Hines was leading the White House's push to pass the Genius Act, Tether—the company with the most at stake in the legislation—was steering millions of dollars to a business he co-owned, according to messages, internal documents and payment records reviewed by The Wall Street Journal.

Hines exchanged Signal messages showing that while he was in the White House, he took part in a group chat with his company partners,

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